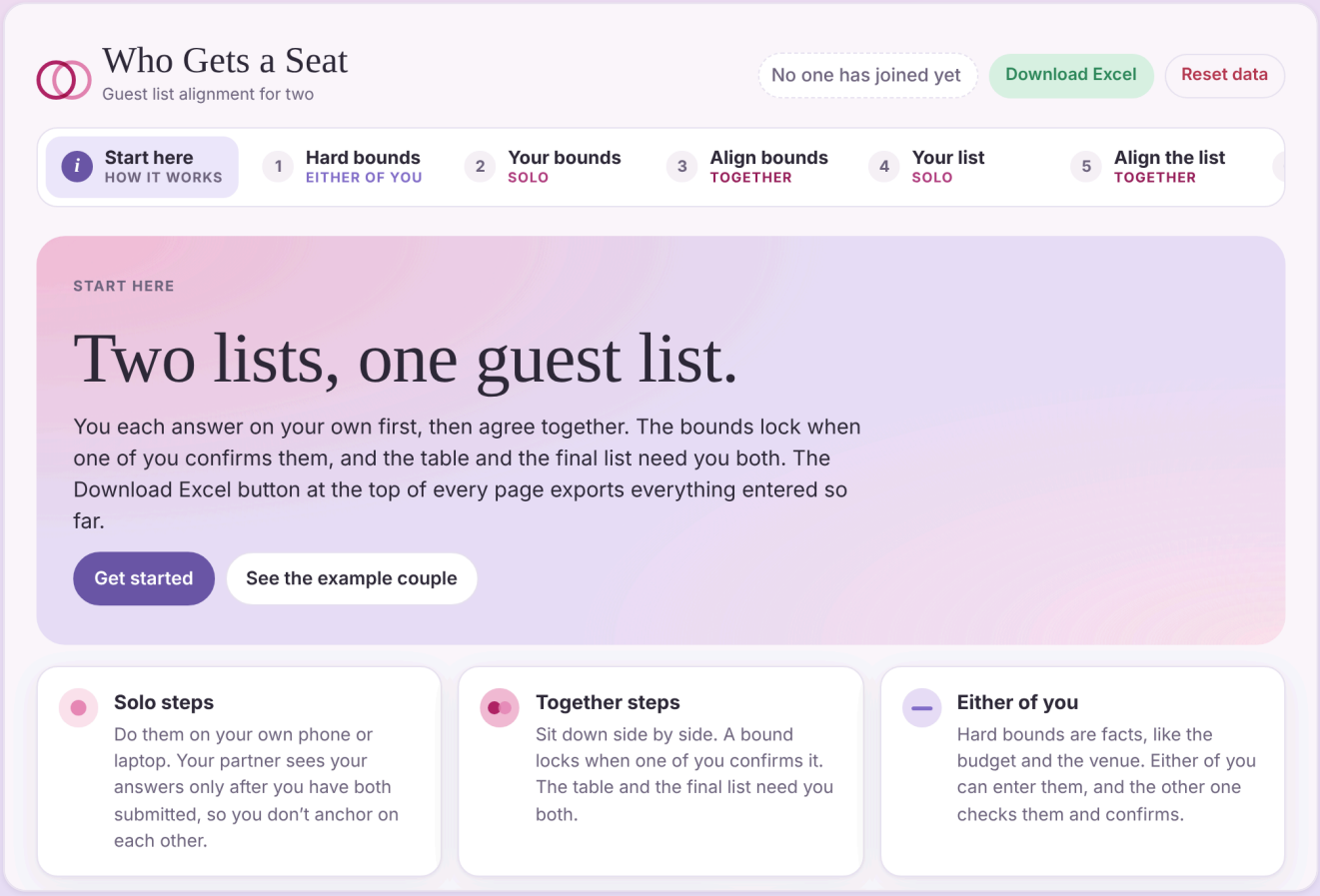
USER GUIDE

Who Gets a Seat

One guest list for two people, built step by step.

You each answer on your own first, then agree together. This guide starts with how to set the app up in Claude from the HTML file, then walks through the seven steps with pictures of how each screen looks.

- Solo: on your own device
- Together: side by side
- Either of you



Set the app up in Claude

Who Gets a Seat is one HTML file. To use it as a shared tool for two people, one of you publishes that file in Claude as a page. Both of you then open the same link.

IF YOU ONLY OPEN THE FILE IN A BROWSER

The app runs as a one-screen preview. The page shows “Saving isn’t available in this view. Changes stay on this screen until you close it.” and Download Excel says it isn’t available. Nothing is shared between the two of you. Publishing the file in Claude with the four capabilities below turns on saving and sharing.

What the page asks Claude for

CAPABILITY	WHAT THE APP USES IT FOR
db	Saves every answer, list and reply in a shared database, so both of you see changes as they happen.
user	Knows who is viewing and whether that person may make changes.
sample	Lets Claude read uploaded lists that are not the Excel template, and look for duplicate names. Without it, a simple reader is used (one name per line or per row).
downloads	Lets you save the Excel file and the Excel template.

Publish it, step by step

1. **Start a new chat in Claude** in the app where Claude can make and publish pages.
2. **Attach the HTML file** to your message.
3. **Paste the request** shown on the right and send it.
4. **Claude publishes the page** and shows a card with its title and link. The page is private to you until you share it.
5. **Open it and check.** The yellow bar “Saving isn’t available in this view” must not be there. If it is, ask Claude to republish the page with the same four capabilities.

Request to paste

```
Please publish the attached HTML file as an
Artifact, exactly as it is. Do not change the
code.

When you publish, declare these runtime
capabilities: db, user, sample and downloads.

Call the page “Who Gets a Seat”. Tell me when
it is live. I will then share it with my
partner.
```

WHAT I TESTED, AND WHAT I DID NOT

These steps are the ones used to publish this app, in the Claude session where it was built. I could not test other Claude apps, other plans, or your partner’s account. What a plan allows (publishing, sharing, the four capabilities) can differ by account.

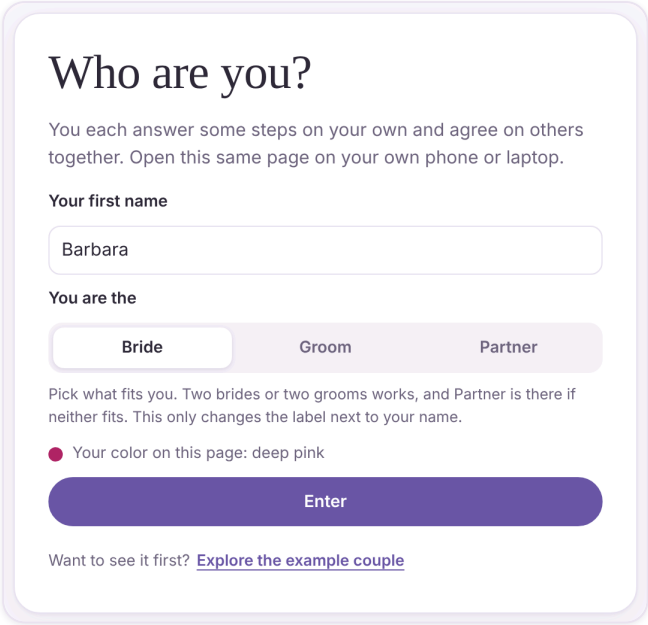
Share it and join

Share with your partner

1. On the page, open the **Share** menu. Only the owner can change sharing, and it is done from there.
2. Give your partner access that lets them **make changes**. If they can only view, they see “You can view this page but not change it. Ask the owner to share it with you as an Editor.”
3. Your partner needs to be **signed in to Claude**. The platform describes the shared database as unavailable to someone who is signed out.

Join

1. Each of you opens **the same link** on your own phone or laptop.
2. Type your first name, pick **Bride**, **Groom** or **Partner**, then press Enter. Two brides or two grooms works too. The pick only changes the label next to your name. Under the buttons the page shows your color: deep pink for the first person to join, light pink for the second. Only two people can join. A third person does not get a join form.
3. Everything saves by itself and shows on your partner’s screen as it happens. **Switch person** lets one device act as either of you, handy when you sit side by side.



The “Who are you?” screen: first name, then your role, then the color you get.

WANT TO LOOK FIRST?

On the start page, **See the example couple** opens a full example with Mia and Leo. Nothing you do there is saved. **Back to your list** returns you to your own data.

Good to know about the setup

NEW VERSION OF THE FILE

Attach the new HTML file and ask Claude to update the existing page, so the link stays the same. The answers live in the page’s database, not in the HTML, so a new version keeps them. This is how the platform describes its database.

STARTING OVER

For a new wedding or a clean start, press **Reset data** in the app, or publish the file again as a separate page, which starts with an empty database.

PRIVACY

Guest names and ratings are stored in that page’s database. Share the link only with your partner. Your partner’s answers stay hidden on screen until you have both submitted. That is a display rule in the app, not a technical lock. This last point is my own inference from how the shared database works.

NEEDS THE INTERNET

The page loads the Excel library from the web when you download an Excel file or the template.

The seven steps at a glance

There are three kinds of steps. The tags in the step bar at the top of the app show which is which.

SOLO

Do it on your own phone or laptop. Your partner sees your answers only after you have both submitted, so you don't anchor on each other.

TOGETHER

Sit down side by side. A bound locks as soon as one of you confirms it. The table and the final list need you both.

EITHER OF YOU

Hard bounds are facts, like the budget and the venue. Either of you can enter them, and the other one checks them and confirms.

1 **Hard bounds** EITHER OF YOU

Currency, food and drinks per guest, total budget and what the venue holds. The result is a hard maximum number of guests.

2 **Your bounds** SOLO

Three slider questions: when it stops feeling like your wedding, how to split the seats between your sides, and the family share of your side.

3 **Align bounds** TOGETHER

Agree the final number of guests, the split and the family shares. One confirm locks each value. Result: the guest cap and the seats per side.

4 **Your list** SOLO

Add your guests (Excel, Word, CSV, text, paste or one by one) and rate each from 0 to 5 on two questions. Ratings can wait.

5 **Align the list** TOGETHER

Combine people who are on both lists, then settle names where your ratings differ by 2 or more. Both submit the table.

6 **Dashboard** TOGETHER

Every guest on a want versus impact map, the seats per side, and a suggestion for each guest. Change any suggestion, then both approve.

7 **RSVP tracker** TOGETHER

Log replies and +1s. Declines and missing +1s free seats, and the next guest on the waitlist moves up.

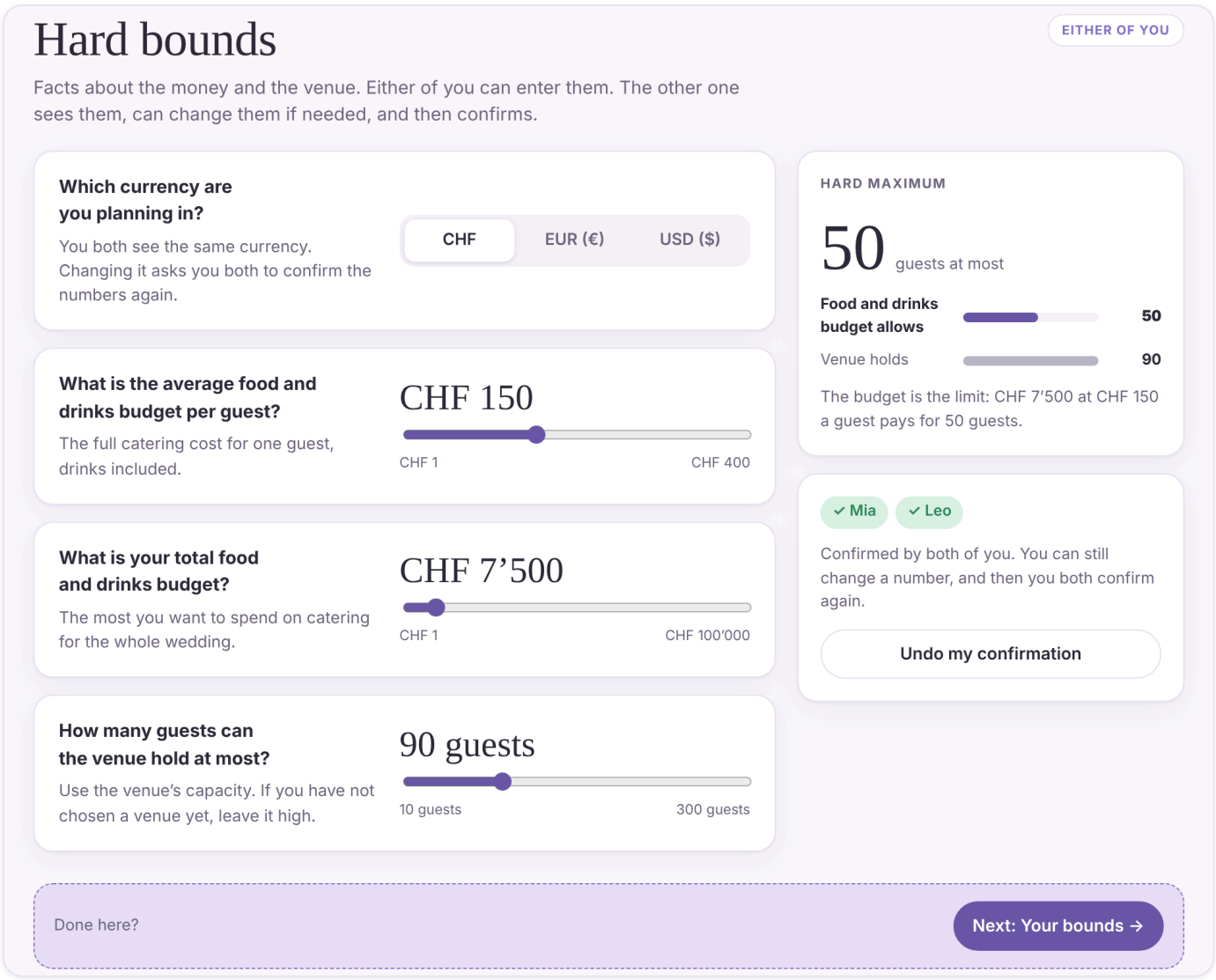
THE "START HERE" TAB

The first tab in the app repeats these steps with an Open button on each, and shows your progress with a tick when a step is done. A button at the top takes you to the next open step.

1 Set the hard bounds

EITHER OF YOU

Facts about the money and the venue. Either of you can enter them. The other one sees them, can change them if needed, and then confirms.



Step 1 on a laptop (example couple). The card on the right shows the hard maximum.

What you do

1. Pick the **currency**: CHF, EUR or USD. Changing it later asks you both to confirm the numbers again.
2. Set the **average food and drinks budget per guest**, including drinks.
3. Set your **total food and drinks budget**, the most you want to spend on catering.
4. Set **how many guests the venue holds** at most. If you have not chosen a venue yet, leave it high.
5. Both of you press `Confirm`. A tick shows who has confirmed. `Undo my confirmation` takes yours back.

THE HARD MAXIMUM

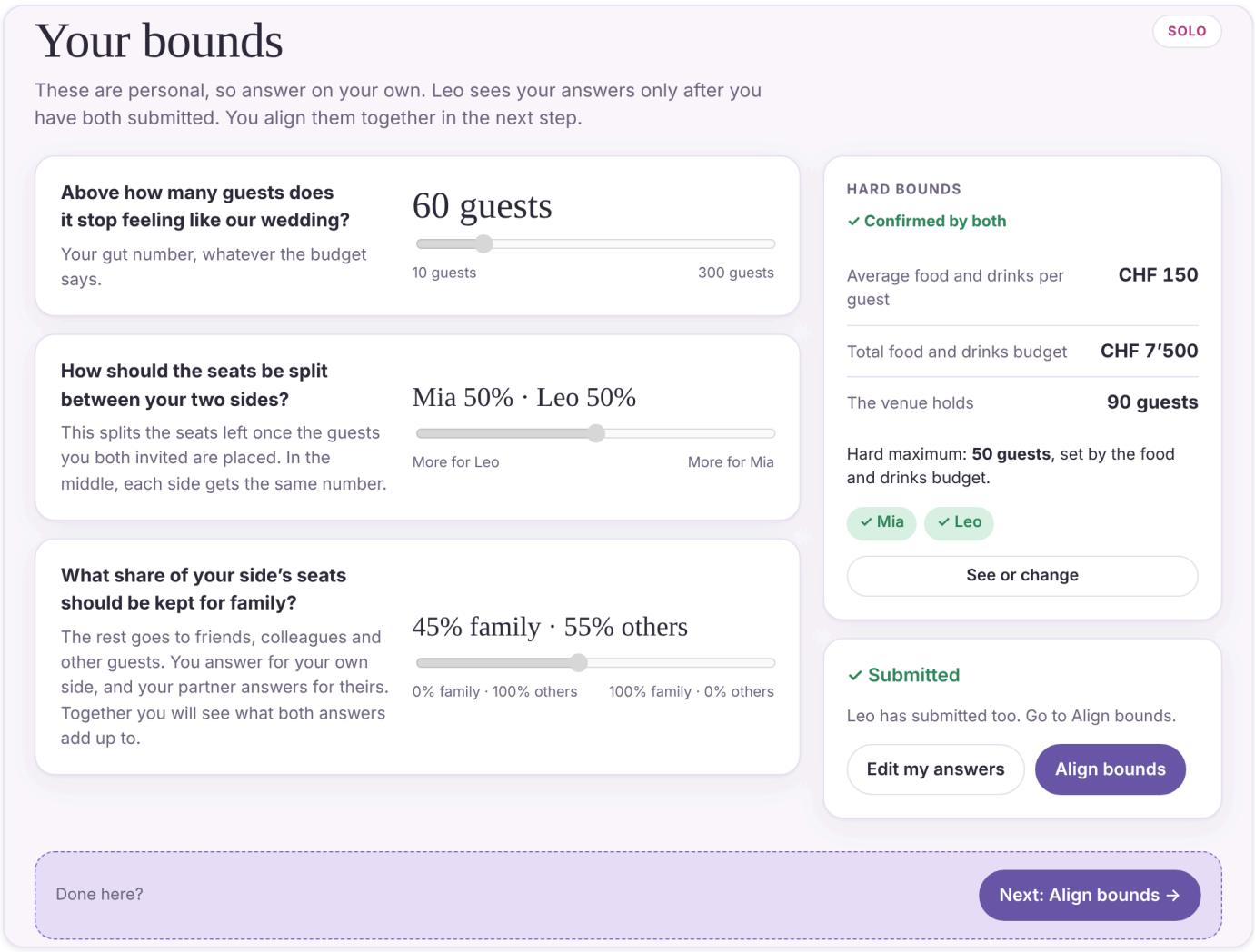
The page shows how many guests the budget pays for (the total budget divided by the budget per guest) and how many the venue holds. The lower of the two is the hard maximum. In the example, CHF 7’500 at CHF 150 a guest pays for 50 guests, so the budget is the limit.

CHANGING A NUMBER

Changing a number removes the confirmations, and you both confirm again. You can still go back to the hard bounds from the later steps.

2 Answer your personal bounds SOLO

These are personal, so answer on your own device. Your partner sees your answers only after you have both submitted. You align them together in the next step.



Step 2 (example couple). The hard bounds sit on the right as a reminder, with a See or change button.

The three questions

1. **Above how many guests does it stop feeling like our wedding?** Your gut number, whatever the budget says. The slider goes from 10 to 300 guests.
2. **How should the seats be split between your two sides?** This splits the seats left once the guests you both invited are placed. In the middle, each side gets the same number.
3. **What share of your side's seats should be kept for family?** The rest goes to friends, colleagues and other guests. You answer for your own side, and your partner answers for theirs.

SUBMIT

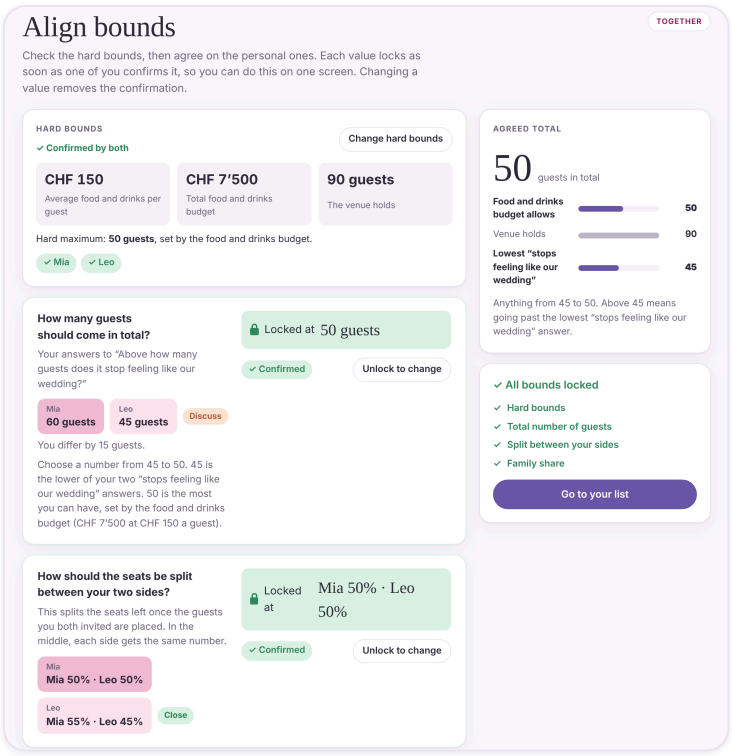
Press **Submit my answers** when you are happy. **Edit my answers** lets you change them again.

WAITING FOR YOUR PARTNER

Once both of you have submitted, the page offers **Align bounds**. You can already start your guest list in the meantime.

3 Align your bounds TOGETHER

Check the hard bounds, then agree on the personal ones. Each value locks as soon as one of you confirms it, so you can do this on one screen. Changing a value removes the confirmation.



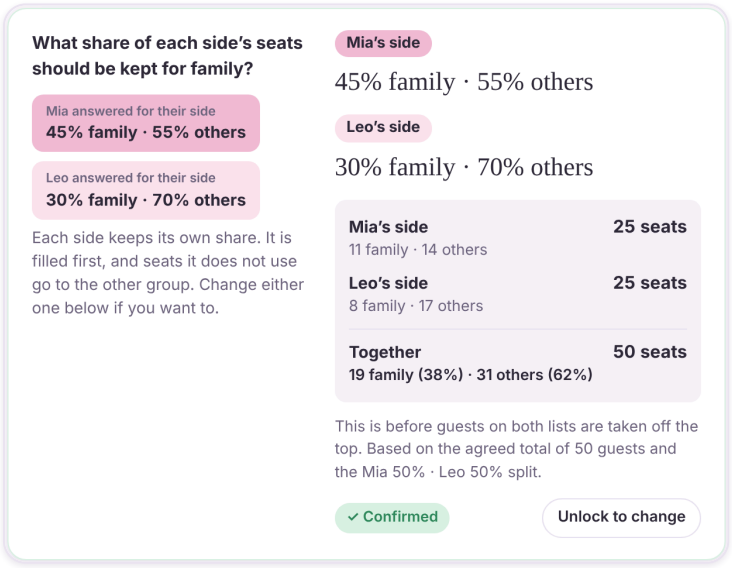
Step 3 (example couple): hard bounds, then the final number and the split.

How a value gets locked

1. Look at both answers. A tag shows whether you are **Close** or need to **Discuss**.
2. Move the slider if you want a different value. For the total number of guests you can pick anything from the lower of your two "stops feeling like our wedding" answers up to the hard maximum. Above the lowest answer means stretching it, and the page says so.
3. Press **Confirm**. One confirm is enough, because you may be in front of one screen.
4. **Unlock to change** takes a locked value back.

FOUR VALUES TO LOCK

The hard bounds, the total number of guests, the split of seats between your sides, and the family share of each side. When all are locked, the page says "All bounds locked" and offers your list.



The family share: each side keeps its own percentage.

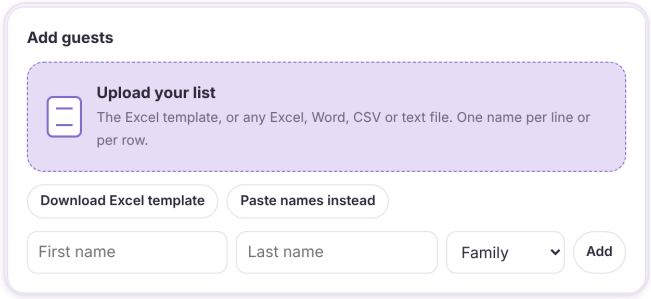
The cards show the seats per side and how they split between family and others, for example "25 seats, 11 family, 14 others". This is before guests on both lists are taken off the top.

4 Build and rate your list SOLO

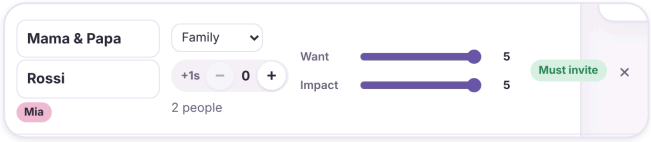
Add your own guests, then rate them. You only rate the guests on your own list. Names are saved as soon as you add them.

Four ways to add guests

1. **The Excel template.** Download Excel template gives you a sheet with First name, Last name, Number of +1 and Guest type (Family, Friend, Colleague, Other). Fill it in and upload it.
2. **Any other file.** Upload Excel, Word, CSV or text (.xlsx, .xls, .csv, .docx, .txt, .ods). Claude reads it and fills the table. PDFs are not supported.
3. **Paste names.** One guest per line, first name then last name.
4. **One by one.** Type a first name (required) and a last name, pick a type, press Add.



The “Add guests” card.



One guest row: first and last name, type, +1 stepper and the two rating sliders.

CHECK BEFORE ADDING

Uploads and pasted names first appear in a review table. Fix names, types and +1s, and untick anyone you do not want. Repeats are flagged and unticked: “Repeated in this file” and “Already in your list”.

Rating each guest, 0 to 5

QUESTION	0 MEANS	5 MEANS
Want them there	Fine without them	Can’t imagine the day without them
Impact if not invited	Nobody would notice	Lasting hurt or family fallout

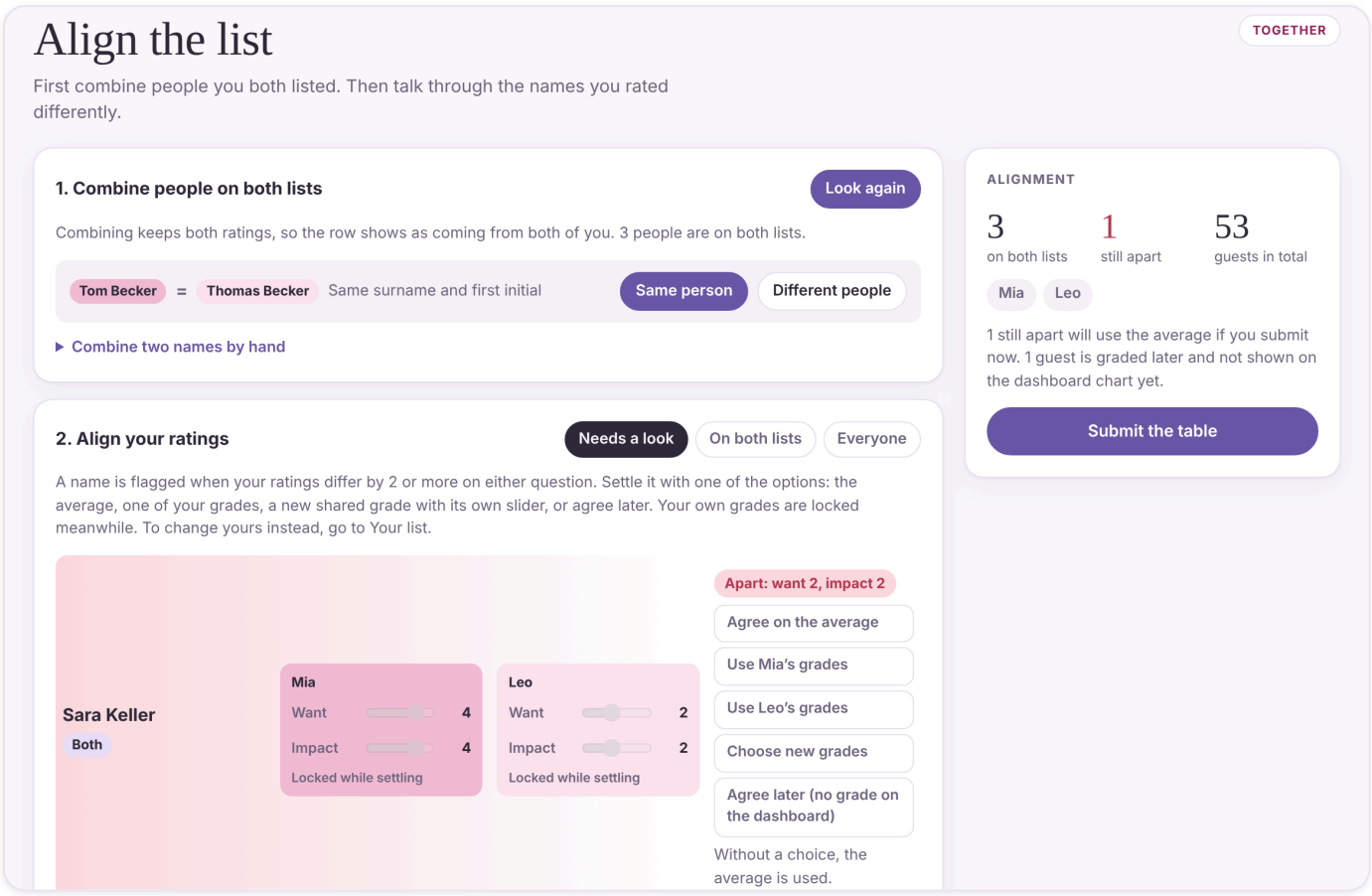
A rating of 2.5 or more counts as high. Set +1s per guest from 0 to 5. Every +1 takes a seat. The card on the right shows your seats used against your side’s seats.

RATING CAN WAIT

You do not need to rate before you submit. The button then reads Submit my list, rating later. Unrated guests show as “Not rated” and stay out of the invited suggestion until you rate them.

5 Align the list TOGETHER

This step opens once you have both submitted your lists. First combine duplicates, then talk through the names you rated differently.



Step 5 (example couple): a possible duplicate at the top, names rated differently below.

1. Combine people on both lists

If you both listed the same person, combine them so they show once and count as coming from both of you. For each suggested pair press **Same person** or **Different people**. You can also combine two names by hand. **Check with Claude** looks for nicknames and typos.

SHARED POOL

Guests on both lists come out of a shared pool of seats. That pool is taken off the top, before the two sides split the remaining seats.

2. Settle your ratings

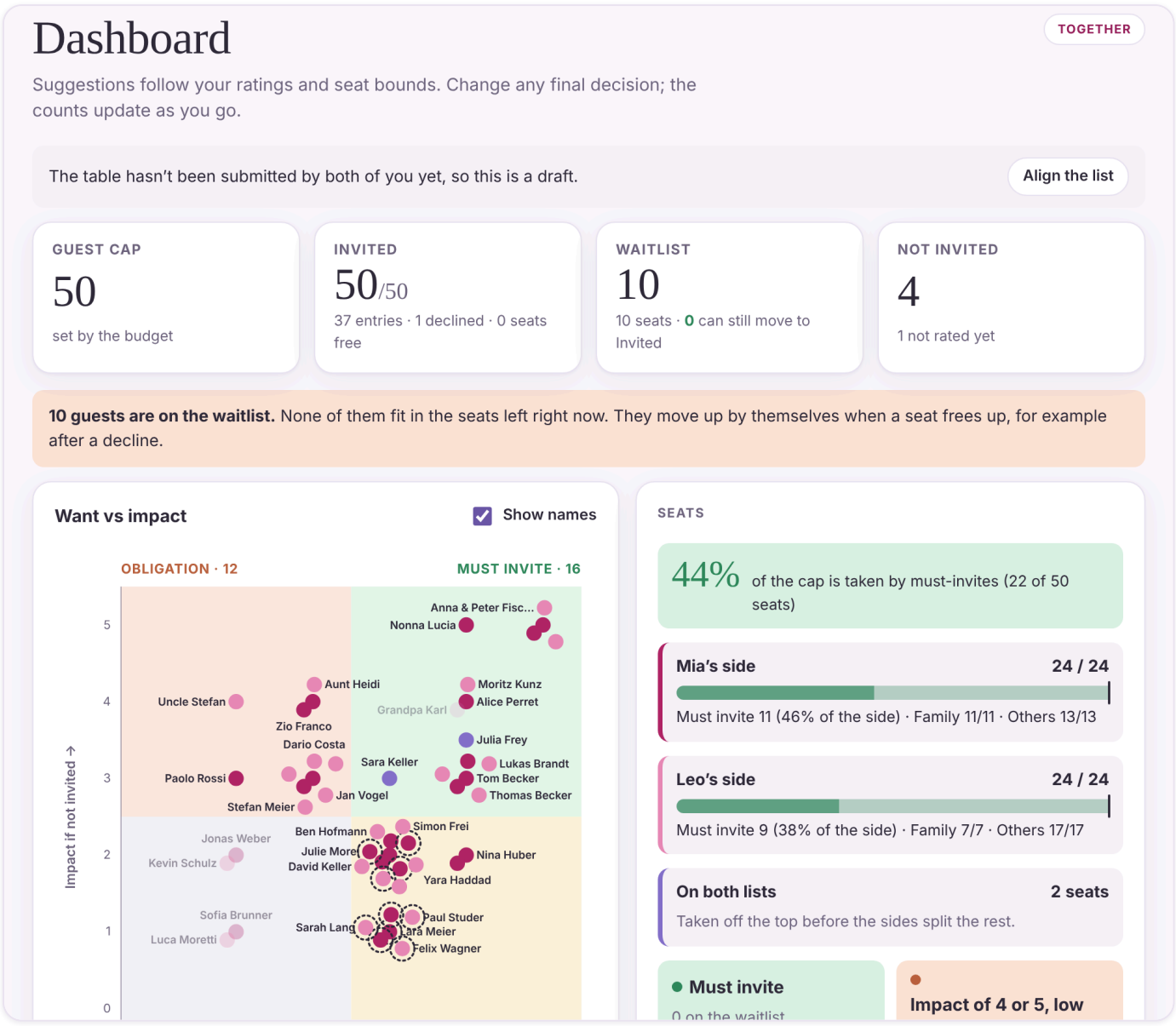
A name is flagged when your two ratings differ by 2 or more on either question. Your own grades are locked while you settle it. Pick one of:

- **Agree on the average,**
- **Use one partner's grades,**
- **Choose new grades:** a shared slider panel appears for the new Want and Impact,
- **Agree later:** no grade on the dashboard yet.

Without a choice, the average is used. To change your own grades instead, go back to Your list. When you are done, each of you presses **Submit the table**.

6 Decide on the dashboard TOGETHER

Every guest is placed on a want versus impact map, and the page suggests who is invited, waitlisted or not invited. Change any suggestion by hand, then both approve.



Step 6 (example couple): the four cards, the 2×2 map and the seat meters.

What you see

- **Four cards:** the guest cap, the invited seats, the waitlist and who is not invited.
- **The waitlist note:** how many waitlisted guests still fit in the free seats. Tap a name to move it up.
- **The 2×2 map:** one dot per guest. Deep pink is one partner (the one who joined first), light pink the other, purple is both. A dotted ring means waitlisted, faded means not invited, transparent means declined. Tap a dot to change that guest.
- **Seat meters:** seats used per side, how many are must invites, and family against other seats.
- **The table:** use the Final column to set Invited, Waitlist or Not invited. `Use all suggestions` undoes manual changes. Filter by group, side or decision.
- **Approve:** press `Approve this list` when you are both happy. Any later change asks you both again.

STEP 6 · HOW THE SUGGESTION WORKS

Who gets invited

The page follows three rules, in this order. A rating of 2.5 or more counts as high. Each rule fills seats only while the guest's side has room.

1. **Must invite: high impact, high want.**
   Impact and want both 2.5 or more. Invited first while their side has seats. Higher impact goes first.

2. **Impact of 4 or 5, low want.**
   Once every must invite has a seat, they get the remaining seats first. A 5 goes before a 4. If there are no seats left, they go on the waitlist.

3. **Other high impact or high want.**
   Impact of 2.5 to under 4 with low want, or low impact with want of 2.5 or more. Invited if their side still has seats, highest total rating first. Otherwise they go on the waitlist.

× **Both ratings under 2.5.**
Not invited.

The four map areas

AREA	RATINGS	RULE
Must invite	High want, high impact	Rule 1
Obligation	Low want, high impact	Rule 2 (impact 4 or 5) or rule 3 (impact 2.5 to under 4)
Joy list	High want, low impact	Rule 3
Skip	Low want, low impact	Not invited

How seats are shared out

- Guests on both lists use the **shared pool** first.
- Each side then keeps a share of seats for **family** and for **others** and fills it first.
- If a share is full but the side still has seats, the next guest in line still gets one, so nobody waits while their side has room.
- A guest is waitlisted only when their side has no seat left.

YOUR DECISION WINS

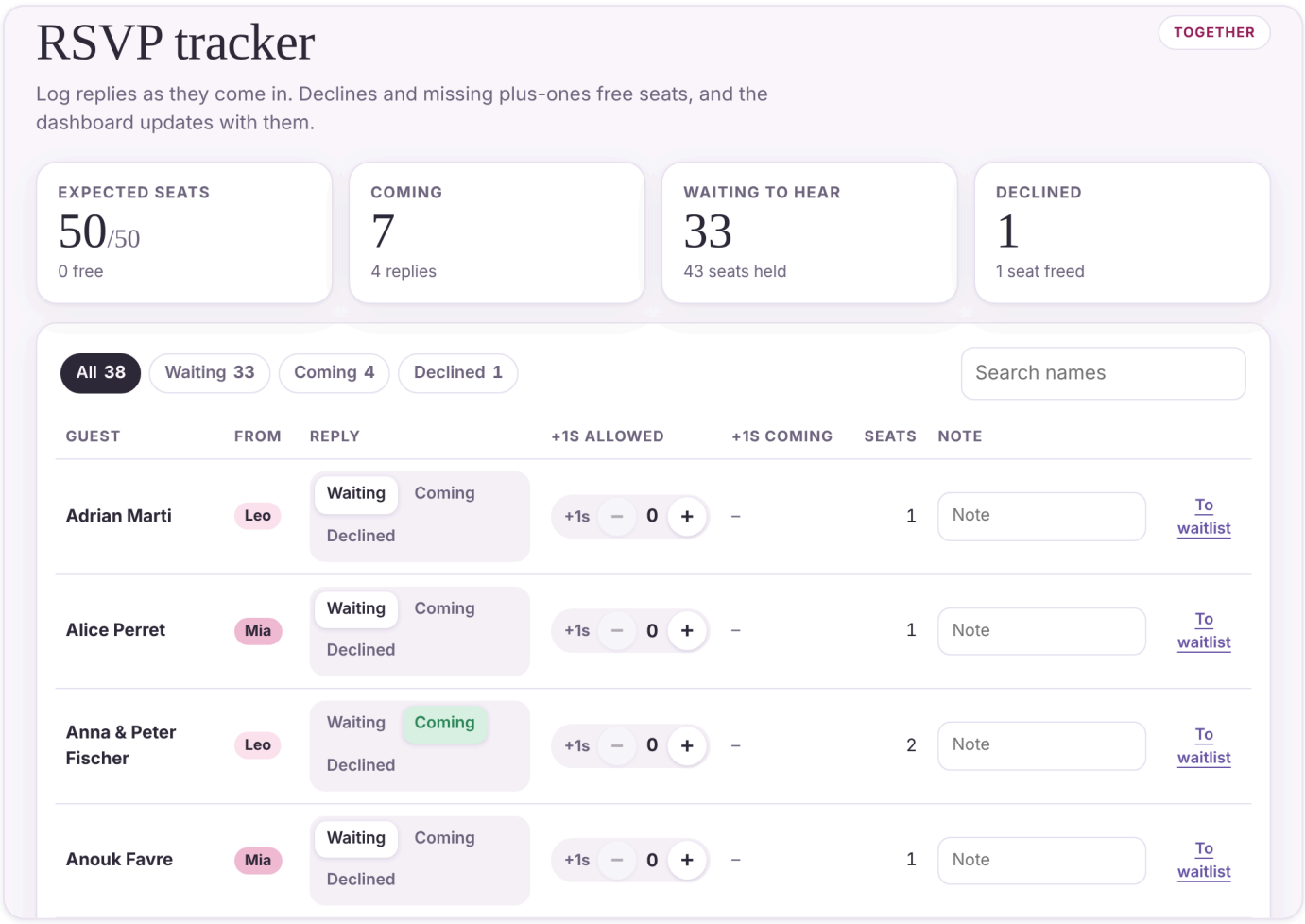
Anything you set by hand in the Final column stays as you set it. If that leaves seats free, the waitlist note lists the guests who now fit, and one tap moves them up.

SEATS COUNT WHAT IS EXPECTED

A guest who declined, or a +1 who is not coming, no longer takes a seat. The next guest in line then moves up by itself.

7 Track the RSVPs TOGETHER

Once the final list is set, send the invitations and use this step to log how people reply. It lists the invited guests, with the waitlist below.



Step 7 (example couple): seat counters on top, then one row per invited guest.

For each invited guest

- Set the reply: **Waiting**, **Coming** or **Declined**.
- If the guest may bring +1s, record how many are actually coming. Until you know, it stays at "?" and the allowed number of seats is held.
- Add a note if you need one. **To waitlist** moves a guest back to the waitlist.

The counters show the expected seats against the cap, how many are coming, how many are still waiting to reply and how many seats were freed by declines.

WHEN SOMEONE DECLINES

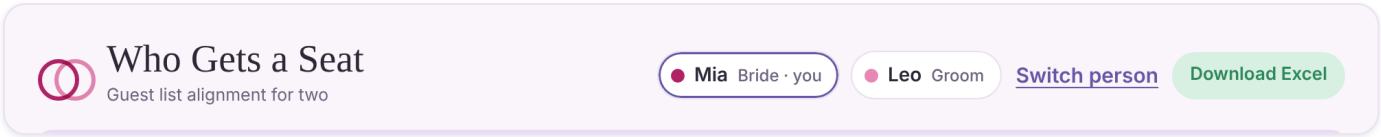
The seats are freed for that guest's own side, or from the shared pool if the guest is on both lists. On the dashboard the dot turns transparent and the Final column reads "Declined". The next guest in line on the waitlist moves up to Invited by itself, and the "Next up" card lists anyone else who fits.

CHANGING YOUR MIND

A decline can be changed back in the tracker. The dashboard follows.

GOOD TO KNOW

Excel, reset and your phone



The header on every tab: who has joined, Switch person, Download Excel and Reset data.

Download Excel

The green button at the top of every tab exports everything entered so far as one Excel file with these sheets:

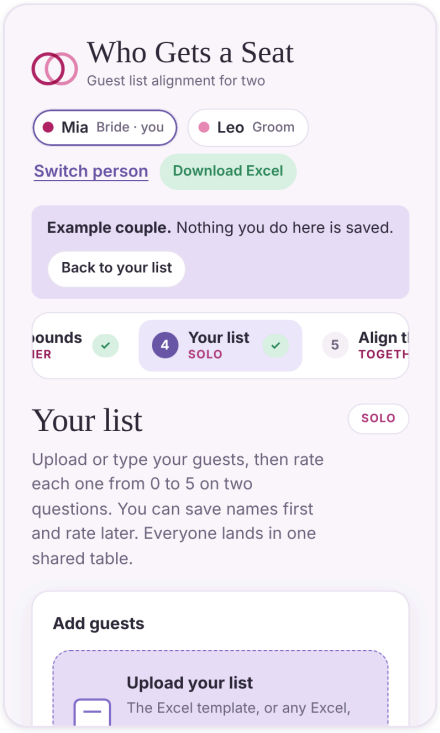
- **Summary and Bounds:** progress, and both answers with the agreed value of each bound
- **Answers for each partner:** their own bounds answers and guest ratings
- **Alignment:** guests on both lists, with ratings when submitted and after aligning
- **Guests:** everything about every guest
- **Final list**, **RSVP tracker** and **Waitlist**

RESET DATA

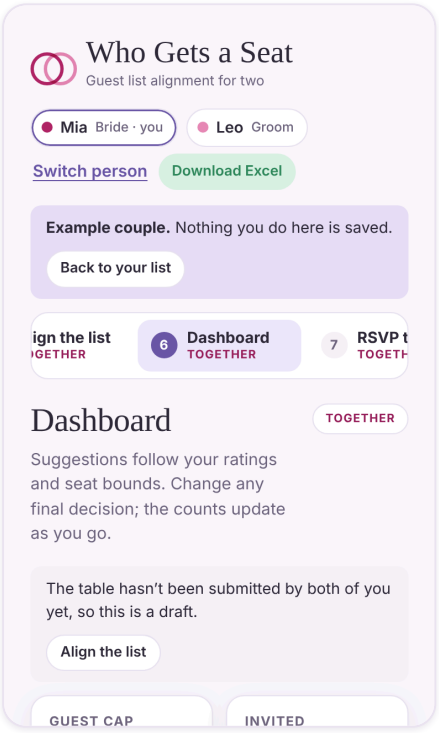
The red button deletes both of your names, every answer, every guest list, all ratings and all RSVP replies. It cannot be undone and it also clears the page for your partner. A confirmation asks first and offers **Download Excel first**.

ON YOUR PHONE

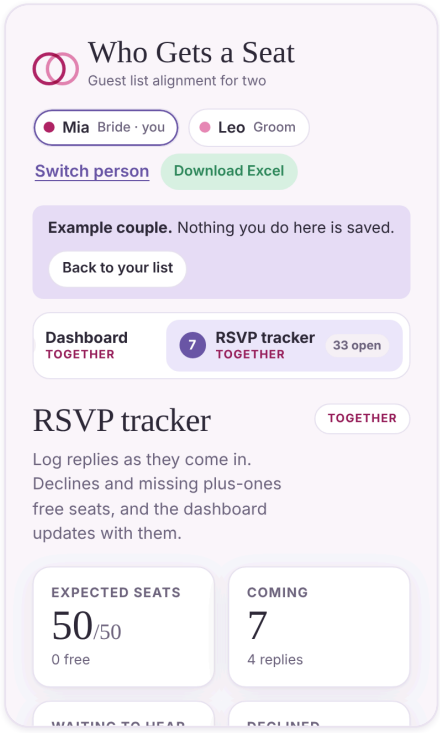
The same steps stack into one column, so each of you can work on your own device. The step tabs scroll sideways at the top, and tables turn into cards.



Your list on a phone



Dashboard on a phone



RSVP tracker on a phone

HELP

If something looks wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
“Saving isn’t available in this view. Changes stay on this screen until you close it.”	The page is not running as a published page with the **db** capability, for example the file was opened directly. Publish it in Claude as in Part 1 and open the link.
“Downloading isn’t available in this view.”	The **downloads** capability is missing. Ask Claude to republish the page declaring db, user, sample and downloads.
“You can view this page but not change it.”	The page owner needs to share it with you with access that lets you make changes, from the Share menu.
“This page lost its connection, so changes are no longer saved.”	Reload the page, then continue. What you entered before the message was saved.
“Couldn’t save that change.”	Check your internet connection and try again. The page retries a few times on its own first.
“Two people have already joined.”	The page has room for exactly two people. If you are one of them, press Continue as and pick your name.
A file you uploaded shows the wrong names, or “a simple reader was used”	Use the review table before adding: edit names, change the type, or untick rows. The simple reader reads one name per line or row. The Excel template always works.
A guest is “Not rated”	Move both rating sliders on that row. If a slider already sits where you want it, tap it once.
Align the list says it is waiting for both lists	Each of you needs to press Submit my list in step 4. Ratings can still be added afterwards.
A guest is on the waitlist although seats are free	A guest is only waitlisted when their own side has no seat left. Seats that are free on the other side do not count. After a hand change, the waitlist note shows who fits.

Words used in the app

Hard bounds	The facts: food and drinks budget and venue size. They give the hard maximum number of guests.
Guest cap	The total number of guests you agree on, at most the hard maximum.
Shared pool	Seats for guests on both lists. They are taken off the top before the two sides split the rest.
Waitlist	A ranked list of guests who are not invited yet. When a seat frees up, the next one in line on that side moves up.
+1	An extra person a guest may bring, from 0 to 5. Each +1 takes a seat.

A TIP FOR A SMOOTH SESSION

Do steps 2 and 4 on your own devices, then sit side by side for steps 3, 5, 6 and 7. Step 1 is quickest with one of you entering the numbers and the other confirming.